⛪ Church Manager v3

Pictorial Offline Setup Guide

Run Church Manager with **no internet at all**. Two offline ways, depending on how many people need it:

Edition A — Offline Edition: one computer, nothing to install. | **Edition B — Server Edition on your own network:** one church computer shares records with office PCs/phones over your Wi-Fi/router — still no internet.

Every picture of Church Manager in this guide is a real screenshot of v3. For going ONLINE later (tunnel or cloud), see the companion Pictorial Online Setup Guide.

Which offline edition?

	Edition A — Offline Edition	Edition B — Server on your network
Best for	One person, one computer	Church office: several staff, shared records
Install	None — open one file	Node.js once, then double-click to start
Accounts	None needed	One login per person, with roles
Includes	Members, Attendance, Events, Giving, Announcements, Reports, **Memos, Budgets**	Everything in A, plus Finance, QR Attendance and add-on modules
Records live	In that computer's browser	On the church computer (data.json)

Edition A — Offline Edition (5 minutes)

1. Copy the **Church-Manager-Offline** folder onto the computer (USB stick is fine) and open it.
2. Double-click **index.html**. Church Manager opens in the computer's browser. That is the whole installation — there is no step 3.

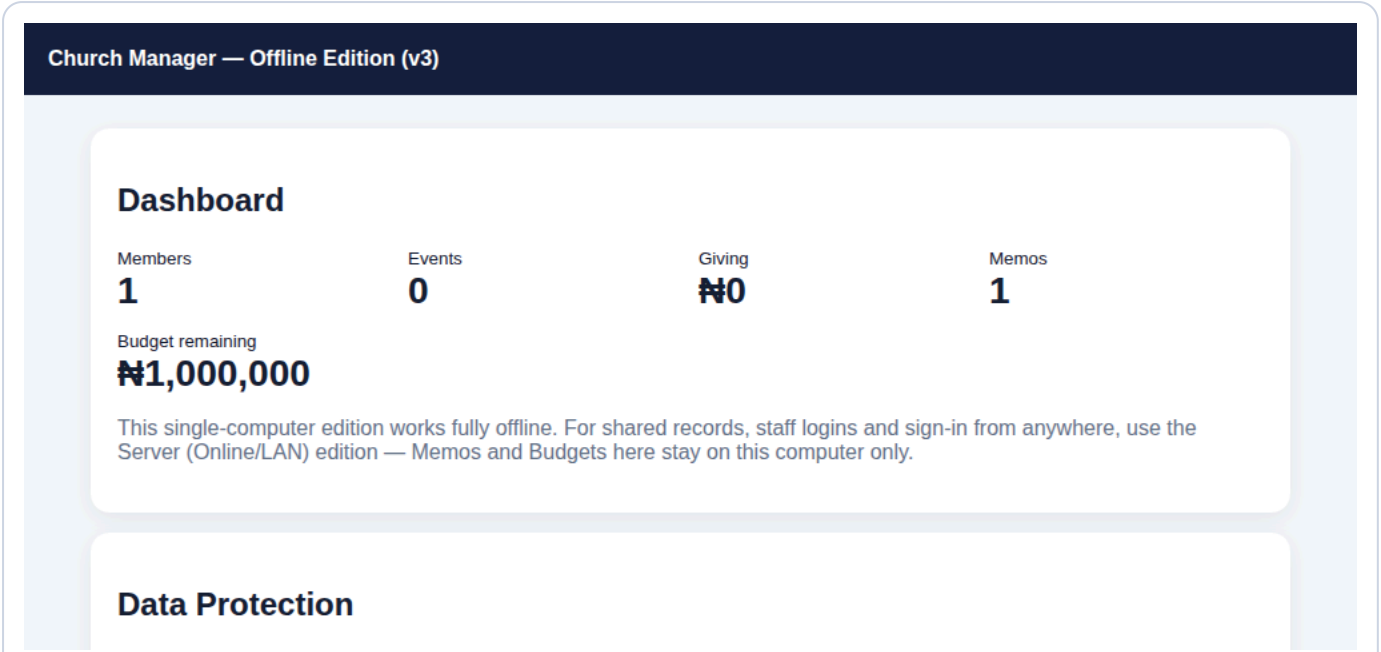


Figure 1 — Real screenshot: the Offline Edition dashboard — members, giving, memos and budget remaining at a glance.

3. **Add your first records:** type a name and phone under **Add Member** and press Save (every member also gets a check-in code). Write office notes under **Memos**, and plan money under **Budgets** — create a budget, then record spending against it as money goes out.
4. **Protect the records (important):** the data lives in this browser on this computer. At least weekly, use the **Data Protection** section: **Export Backup** saves a file — keep copies on a USB stick or another computer. **Restore Backup** loads a saved file back (it replaces current data — use it only on purpose).

Three rules for Edition A: always use the **same browser** (records saved in Chrome are not visible in Edge); never use a **private/incognito** window; and if the computer is replaced, restore from your exported backup file on the new one.

Edition B — Server Edition on your church network



One computer runs the program; everyone else opens it in their browser using that computer's address on your network. No internet is used.

1. **Install Node.js once** on the church PC: from **nodejs.org** download the **LTS** version and install it (keep clicking Next). You only ever do this once.
2. Copy the **Church-Manager-LAN-Tailscale** folder onto the church PC (for example into Documents).
3. **First run only:** right-click **ALLOW-FIREWALL-AS-ADMIN.bat** → **Run as administrator** so other office devices can reach it, then right-click **CREATE-DESKTOP-SHORTCUT.bat** → **Run as administrator** for an easy start icon.
4. Double-click **START-CHURCH-MANAGER.bat** (or the desktop shortcut). A window opens and stays open — that window *is* the server. Leave it running while the office works.
5. On the same PC open **http://localhost:3000**. The first screens ask for your licence key, then your church and Owner details:

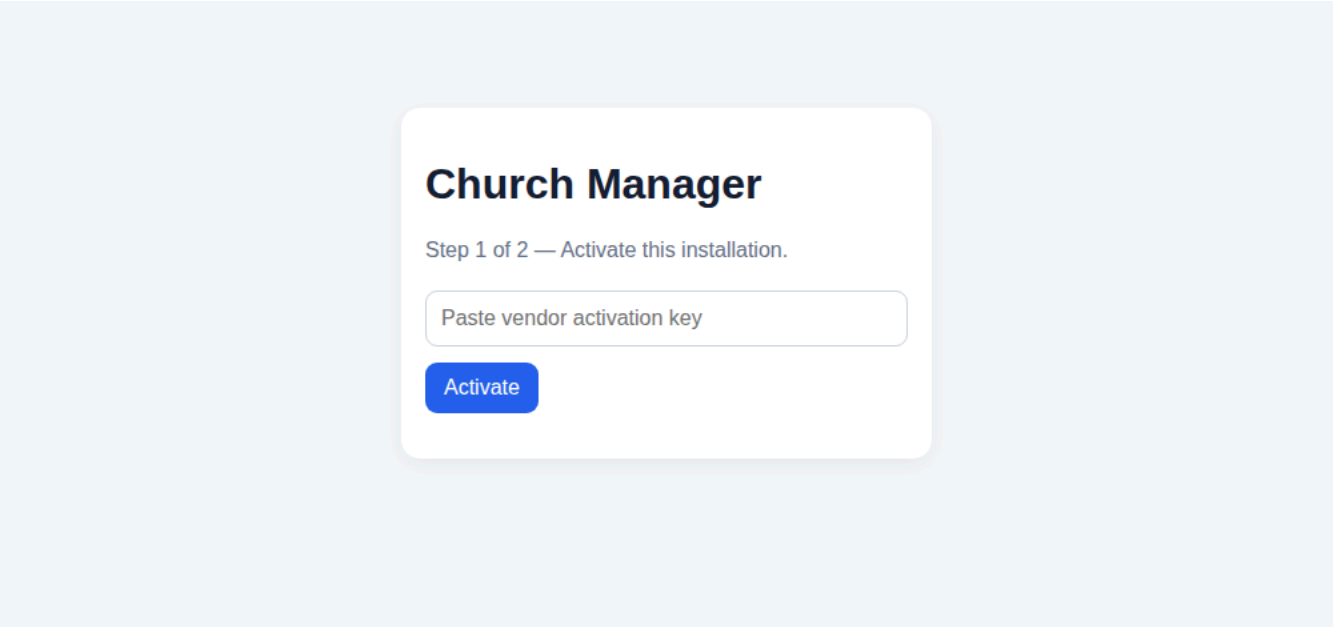


Figure 2 — Real screenshot: Step 1 of 2 — paste the activation key you received from your vendor, then press Activate.

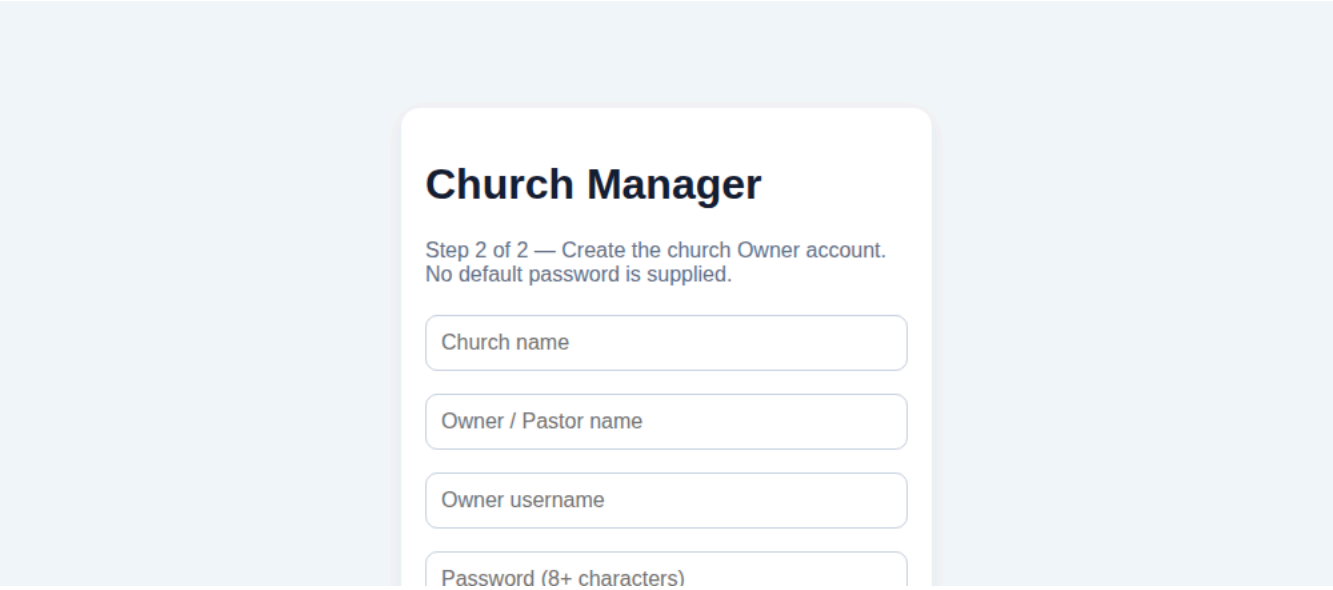


Figure 3 — Real screenshot: Step 2 of 2 — church name, Owner name, and the Owner username and password you choose (no default password exists).

6 **Let staff in:** as Owner, open **Staff Accounts** and create one account per person with their role (Admin, Secretary, Treasurer, Worker). Each person then signs in with their own account — never a shared one.

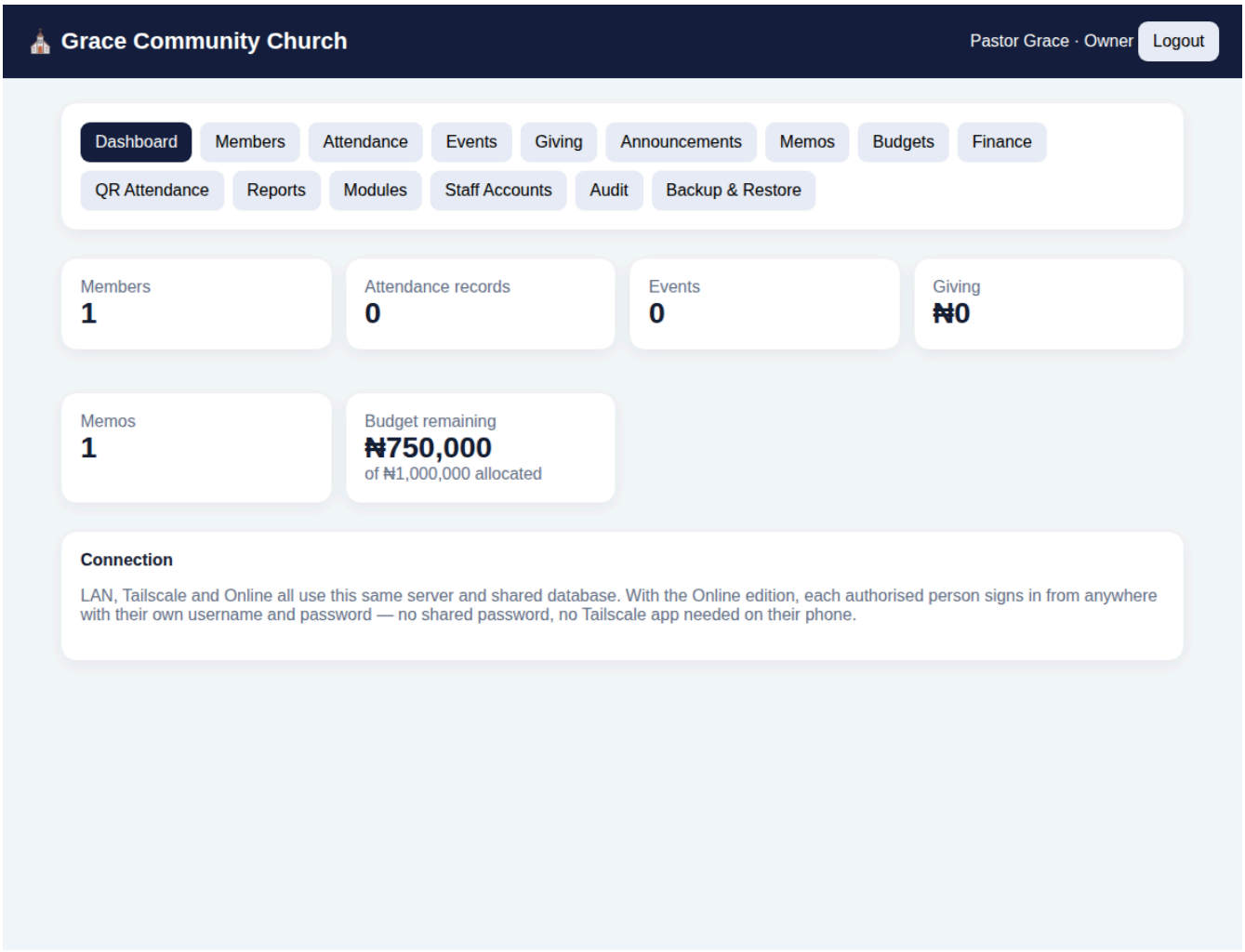


Figure 4 — Real screenshot: the Owner dashboard after sign-in, with Memos, Budgets, Finance and QR Attendance.

7. **Connect the other office devices:** find the church PC's network address (shown in the black server window, e.g. **192.168.1.50**). On any PC or phone connected to the **same router/Wi-Fi**, open **http://192.168.1.50:3000** and sign in. (Address differs per network — use the one your window shows.)

Daily routine: start the church PC → double-click the shortcut → staff sign in. To stop at close of day, close the server window. Records are saved automatically in **data.json** in the server folder — include that folder in your normal backups, and also download an in-app backup weekly (Owner → Backup & Restore).

Moving up later

Offline Edition → Server Edition: the two editions keep separate records; there is no automatic transfer. Enter the key records in the Server Edition (or keep the Offline file as an archive).

Server on your network → Online: nothing to reinstall. Your records move with one in-app backup from the PC, restored on the online copy. Follow the **Pictorial Online Setup Guide** (free tunnel or always-on cloud).

Troubleshooting (offline)

Problem	Edition	Fix

Records "disappeared"	A	You opened a different browser, or a private window. Reopen the same browser normally. If truly lost, Restore Backup.
index.html opens but buttons do nothing	A	JavaScript is blocked in that browser — try Chrome/Edge, or open via the server edition instead.
"node is not recognized"	B	Node.js is not installed (or the PC restarted mid-install). Install the LTS version, restart the PC, try again.
Other devices can't open the address	B	Check: same Wi-Fi/router · server window still open · firewall bat was run as administrator · address copied exactly, including **:3000**.
Page asks for activation again	B	The licence file lives in the server folder (license.json). If the folder was moved, move the whole folder together, or paste the key again.
Forgot the Owner password	B	Stop the server; with the vendor's help the password can be reset from the server folder. Staff passwords are reset by the Owner in Staff Accounts.